2016–2019, the Ram Mandir and Hindu-related issues were closely followed by education as the third most important topic. This is different from the BJP's usage of Facebook: the top topics were Narendra Modi, the BJP, Amit Shah, the Congress (in that order); the Ram Mandir came in nineteenth and 'Hindu' issues at twenty-seventh. This does not at all mean that these issues are less important to the BJP: they remain at the heart of its political differentiation. The patterns only reflect the party's wider communications strategy, which is much more spread out across political issues as a whole.

The interesting thing is that the RSS focuses much less on Narendra Modi than the BJP and Modi himself do. The Narad Index shows that, in the 2016–2019 period, the Sangh spoke the least about Modi. Even less than the Congress did (see Figure 13.2). This may be rooted in a long-held Sangh belief, inculcated by its founder Hedgewar (often referred to as Doctorji), that individuals must not be venerated. Hedgewar himself is said to have only reluctantly accepted the title of sarsanghchalak[2] on 9–10 November in 1929, four years after he founded the RSS.[3] He also ensured that the RSS considers the saffron flag its real 'Guru', rather than any individual.[4] Hedgewar also started the RSS tradition of commencing 'daily activities with [a] salutation to the Bhagwa Dhwaj' in 1926.[5]

Figure 13.2: RSS Speaks Much Less about Modi than the BJP or the Congress (2016–2019)